

	Category	Question	Answer
1	Incumbent Contract Information	Are there current contracts and contractors performing any of these tasks? If so, what are the contractor names and contract numbers?	No, we currently do not have any contracts or contractors performing these tasks.
2	Architecture & Mainframe Environment	What specific mainframe platforms and programming environments are currently in use (e.g., z/OS, ADABAS/Natural, COBOL versions)?	Most specifically, ADABAS/Natural, JCL
3	Architecture & Mainframe Environment	What enterprise scheduler is used for batch orchestration, and how are job dependencies and execution comparisons currently managed?	Control M and Control O
4	Architecture & Mainframe Environment	Is the government expecting to convert and migrate mainframe applications to cloud platforms?	Possibly, although we have not arrived there yet. It has been in discussions.
5	Payroll Operational Constraints	What is the payroll processing frequency and peak processing window?	Bi-weekly processing. Peak processing is within 4th quarter of calendar year and most likely due to year-end processing.
6	Payroll Operational Constraints	May AI-enabled capabilities participate in controlled execution workflows under defined safeguards?	In some areas, possibly. We would want to ensure security and privacy standards are honored and held intact.
7	Data & Database Management	What database platforms support payroll and personnel systems, and how is schema or configuration change management handled across environments?	Database platforms which support our payroll/personnel systems include
8	Data & Database Management	What are the approximate database sizes and daily transaction volumes supporting payroll and personnel operations?	Database size approx. 35 TB, daily transactions approx. 1.2 Million/ 4.8 million per week
9	Data & Database Management	Can you clarify the intended meaning of 'ability to scan various LLMs (large language models) in its entirety under the Analyze Code and Infrastructures objective'?	Because our codebase is fairly extensive and nearly 30 years old, we would like for the tool to assist with identifying specific areas in the code. Example, timeframes when code was modified or seek bugs within the code. Is there potential to translate the code to a different language base?
10	AI Model Usage & Data Sensitivity	Must AI capabilities operate exclusively within DOI-controlled infrastructure?	For our payroll/personnel system, yes that is the preference. Pertaining to sub and supporting systems which do not contain PII data, we may have flexibility.
11	AI Model Usage & Data Sensitivity	Are probabilistic AI outputs expected to be limited to analytical and advisory use cases, or may they support operational workflows under defined governance and audit controls?	The output will likely support defined operational work flows.
12	AI Model Usage & Data Sensitivity	Will the AI solution need to process, access, or be trained on data containing PII? If so, are there data residency or data handling requirements beyond FedRAMP alignment?	Yes, data may contain PII. This may also involve standards outlined by FISMA, NIST 800-53 (for authentication), Privacy Act of 1974, Zero Trust Alignment
13	Integration Architecture	Are integrations with external partners (e.g., OPM, IRS, SSPs) primarily file-based, API-based, message-queue based, or hybrid?	External integrations are primarily file based.
14	Integration Architecture	Are integrations strictly batch-driven, or are near real-time capabilities required in certain domains?	Primarily Batch-driven via transmission files.
15	Security & Compliance	Does IBC-HRD require an existing FedRAMP Authorization at a specific baseline, or will a Government-owned, Contractor-operated deployment aligned to the applicable NIST 800-53 baseline within DOI's security boundary be acceptable?	If the application will be cloud based, FedRAMP will be required.
16	Security & Compliance	What logging, auditability, and retention requirements apply to AI-generated outputs and automation workflows?	Audit requirements would be focused on our primary systems and not on AI output.
17	Scalability & Resilience	What peak concurrency and throughput expectations should proposed AI-enabled solutions be architected to support?	Unknown at this time
18	Scalability & Resilience	What Recovery Time Objective (RTO) and Recovery Point Objective (RPO) thresholds must be met for AI-enabled systems operating in payroll-supporting environments?	24 hour RTO/RPO
19	Scalability & Resilience	Of the 300,000+ employees serviced by HRD systems, how many concurrent users are anticipated for the AI-enabled tools and applications? Are usage patterns expected to be steady-state or concentrated around payroll cycles and peak processing windows?	HRD PERS #
20	Governance & Oversight	Is there an established AI governance framework that proposed tools must align with?	YES - DOI (OCIO) POLICY AND MEMORANDUMS. USG (??)
21	Governance & Oversight	Which mission-critical workflows require mandatory human review or approval before production execution?	Medium and High Risk enhancements/features/capabilities require System Owner approvals before migration/deployment into production environments.
22	Testing & Modular Architecture	Does IBC-HRD require the proposed AI tool to natively provide automated testing capabilities, or will integrated testing automation delivered through complementary enterprise platforms be considered acceptable?	Hybrid - depending on Testing being completed (Role based)
23	Strategic Alignment & Implementation	Does IBC-HRD anticipate prioritizing specific capability domains for initial implementation phases?	To be determined
24	Strategic Alignment & Implementation	Which of the listed objectives represent the greatest operational risk or resource burden within the current HRD environment?	refer back to RFI objectives (mainframe)
25	Strategic Alignment & Implementation	Is the primary intent to enhance the existing mainframe-centric architecture, or to support longer-term modernization initiatives?	Initial intent would be support for existing systems/architecture. Long term support will likely be for modernization initiatives
26	Strategic Alignment & Implementation	What measurable performance improvements will define success for AI-enabled automation?	Efficiencies in processes for reduces labor force.
27	Strategic Alignment & Implementation	Will AI-enabled customer service capabilities support internal HRD staff only, or external federal employees serviced by HRD?	Currently it will support HRD staff only but could support customer service processes for IBC customers as well.
28	Submission Clarification	Given the 7-page maximum for Section 2 and the breadth of objectives listed, should vendors address all objectives at a summary level or prioritize a subset in greater depth?	Vendor's discretion
29	Scope of Solution Integration	Does HRD anticipate a single integrated AI platform addressing all listed domains (testing automation, batch processing, database management, code analysis, documentation, customer service automation, etc.), or are modular, multi-vendor solutions acceptable if they meet interoperability and security requirements?	No, open to options. All options must meet FEDRAMP specifications/certifications.

30	Clarification on “LLM Scanning”	The RFI references the ability to “scan various LLMs in its entirety.” Can HRD clarify whether this refers to scanning large language models, legacy language modules, or both?	Both
31	Non-Multi-Tenant Requirement	For the requirement that the AI tool “will not be a multi tenant environment for users outside of IBC HRD,” is a logically isolated single tenant environment within a FedRAMP authorized boundary acceptable, or is physical isolation required?	FedRamp authorized boundary
32	FedRAMP Alignment vs. Authorization	The RFI states that solutions must “align with FedRAMP controls.” Is FedRAMP authorization required at this stage, or is alignment with the controls sufficient for RFI purposes?	Controls must be going through FedRamp authorization process; or already approved.
33	Availability of Sample Artifacts	Will HRD provide sample JCL, anonymized payroll scenarios, or representative data structures to help vendors accurately scope automation capabilities?	Samples maybe provided during Technical Evaluation period.
34	Integration Expectations with Federal Partner	For integrations with OPM, IRS, SSPs, AQD, FMD, and OMB, should vendors assume real-time interoperability, batch-based exchanges, or both?	Both
35	ROM Pricing Granularity	Does HRD prefer ROM pricing broken out by major capability area (e.g., testing automation, database automation, payroll automation), or at the overall solution level?	Yes- broken out by major capability area.
36	Vendor One-on-One Sessions	If HRD conducts one-on-one sessions, will vendors be notified in advance of the specific capabilities or focus areas HRD wishes to review?	Some focal points will be provided but a high level overview of application capabilities will be appreciated.
37		Is there a timeline and/or milestone for mainframe modernization (components) to cloud infrastructure?	To be determined
38		Is a hybrid cloud deployment model part of the mainframe modernization strategy?”	To be determined
39		What is the current operating system and version for the mainframe?	ZOS 2.5 (3.2 scheduled for migration this FY)
40		If legacy, are you willing to upgrade to the latest mainframe operating system?	Yes
41		What is the current mainframe database and version?	ADABAS 8.6
42		What are the data native formats, record formats, and compatibility requirements for running data preprocessing for machine learning on the mainframe?	EBCDIC
43		If data moves off mainframe, are there requirements in how data quality, privacy, and security shall be managed?	Yes, must meet NIST requirements
44		What are the different mainframe tools/software components being used for the DB query, transaction processing, configuration management, workload, file, security access, etc.	No specific tools
45		Are there interests to expand to Quantum?	Would be interested to learn more about
46		What does success look like? What are the specific business objectives and desired results?	See RFI
47		Is real-time data actions needed or will batch processing suffice majority of the requirements?	Both
48		Are you prioritizing on-platform inference (mainframe-centric) running machine learning directly on the mainframe for the Online/Production jobs or can offloading to a cloud/hybrid environment (using AWS/Azure/GCP) be consider?	Open to options or consideration
49		For the Customer Service Ticket Generation objectives (customer service workflow), do you consider this sub system complement as ancillary in support of the mainframe. Example, support system (e.g. like ServiceNow)? Verse this is on-platform sub system mainframe feature running inside the mainframe.	Ancillary support system (ie. ServiceNow)
50		For the Self Help Feature objectives in support of customer service do you consider these ancillary in support or also seeking support that require features to be on-platform running inside the mainframe.	Ancillary
51		Please provide number of end users and administrators in related to training.	Range up to 175 personnel. Depends upon Application / Mainframe
52		Is there a page limit, font requirement for the Rough Order of Magnitude in Section 3?	2 pages limit
53	“IBC’s Human Resources Directorate seeks information from industry on AI tools and applications capable of securely supporting.. across the full systems software development lifecycle...”	To take full advantage of best-in-class AI capabilities, does IBC-HRD consider a combination of complementary AI platforms and tools—working together within a cohesive, secure architecture—to be responsive, rather than requiring a single, monolithic AI platform?	Combination.
54	“Mainframe-centric, payroll-focused, PII-regulated environment...”	Should vendors assume direct integration with the existing mainframe payroll environment?	Yes
55	“Additional areas of interest include AI-enabled code and infrastructure analysis and refactoring (mainframe module assessment, call-routine mapping, bug identification, historical change analysis, and LLM-based scanning)...”	Does DOI IBC envision the future of FPPS as a modernization of the existing mainframe platform (e.g., incremental enhancement and refactoring), a partial refactor with selective component replacement, or a full system replacement? Please describe the desired endstate and planning horizon, if defined.	To be determined
56	Analyze code and infrastructures – Ability to scan various LLMs (large language models) in its entirety	Can HRD clarify the intent of “ability to scan various LLMs in its entirety”? Is this referring to evaluating LLM outputs for accuracy, bias, and security, or describing the use of LLMs to scan HRD’s codebase?	Intent is for both

57	"IBC Policies and Security – FedRAMP-aligned controls"	To take full advantage of emerging commercial products and technologies, does IBGHRD consider phased FedRAMP authorization approaches—such as government sponsorship, interim deployment models, or limited-scope authorizations—acceptable for solutions that are not yet fully FedRAMP authorized?	Yes
58	Please limit your response to each business requirement to 2 pages... (7-page maximum)	To accommodate vendors with multiple relevant solutions, would the government revise this requirement to a 10-page overall limit for section 2, with no limit per individual requirement?	No - prioritize recommended solution
59	"IBC-HRD welcomes a wide range of submission formats..."	Are architecture diagrams, workflow visuals, screenshots, or process flows counted toward the seven-page limit, or may they be included as embedded graphics or appendices?	May be included as embedded graphics or appendices
60	Creative Pricing Expectations	Is there a ceiling or budget range HRD can share for planning purposes?	To be determined
61		Are there specific performance metrics or KPIs that HRD will use to evaluate the effectiveness of AI tools?	Policy and expectations are being provided by DOI/OCIO and internally to IBC
62		What are the performance and scalability requirements for AI tools (e.g. concurrent batch jobs, throughput)?	Unknown at this time
63		Could you provide more detail on the types of external systems and integration points that AI solutions must support and any associated security or compliance constraints?	Ticketing, Time & Attendance, workforce tracking, learning management, data warehouse, change management systems must all maintain standards outlined by FISMA, NIST 800-53 (for authentication), Privacy Act of 1974, Zero Trust Alignment
64		Can you confirm any constraints on AI model training or inference with PII data, including restrictions on what artifacts or training materials the AI is permitted to access?	Must be FedRamp or going through Fedramp approvals/certification
65		What CI/CD processes do you currently have, what is the maturity level, and where are the key capability gaps?	No processes currently CI/CD
66		Can the government provide a technical systems architecture diagram of the integrated personnel/payroll system and its supporting sub systems?	Not at this time
67		Can the government provide a network topology diagram, including existing cloud connections (if any)?	Not at this time
68		Can the government provide an inventory of the integrated personnel/payroll system and its subsystems, and confirm whether existing external system agreements allow AI interaction and require AI to reconcile or map data across partners like OPM, IRS, SSA, SSPs, FMD, and AQD?	DOI and OCIO have provided policy and guidance
69		Is there a SIEM/SOAR solution with centralized security logs and responses?	No
70		What is HRD's preferred timeline for AI solution implementation and deployment?	To be determined
71		What system documentation and training materials currently exist and at what levels (code, system, business processes)?	Internal to HRD and ranges between working groups dependent on roles/duties
72		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for Cross platform compatibility? Are there preferred orchestration tools (Control-M, CA7, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps)?	Control-M/JCL/Interface Files
73		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for Testing/automated testing, if anything? Are there preferred orchestration tools (Control-M, CA7, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps)?	Currently, no automated testing
74		How do you currently do job batch processing (Automated job run and compares) today?	Automated and manual.
75		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for analyzing code and infrastructures, if anything? Are there preferred orchestration tools?	Mostly manually conducted and stored internally
76		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for system documentation and training materials, if anything? Are there preferred tools?	Mostly manually conducted and stored internally
77		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for data analysis reports among systems, if any? Are there preferred tools?	Mostly manually conducted and stored internally
78		What existing software, processes, and approach do you use for Self Help Features, if any? Are there preferred tools?	None exist currently, only internal job aids are produced from one area to the next nor are maintained
79		To what extent does HRD expect AI tools to automate business-rule-aware validation for W-2, ACA, locality pay, retroactive pay logic, and other HRD-specific calculations?	Automated for compare versions per prompts
80		Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements of the RFI lists access to sandbox environment for hands-on exploration that can include guided demo sessions, sample data sets, or interactive tutorials. For realistic demo sessions, will HRD provide sample, historical, or synthetic partner files for development and testing?	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and To be determined how in depth or to what quantity
81		One of DOI IBC-HRD's objectives is "Create system documentation...". For what functions should new documentation be generated (i.e., code documentation, system technical designs, business processes), and what formats are preferred (DITA, XML, PDF, Word, Confluence)?	Any and all - To be determined and discussed internally and with vendor
82		Must all AI components run inside a non-multi-tenant, FedRAMP High or Moderate-aligned environment?	Must be FedRamp or going through Fedramp approvals/certification

83		What processes and software are used for capturing service tickets?	ServiceNow - tickets generated by HRD staff, customer clients, and customer service Tier 1
84		What is the current ticketing/service management system and its integration requirements?	ServiceNow - no current integration developed and maintained outside of mainframe or other sub systems
85		Does HRD have well documented data catalogs for AI analysis of databases?	Yes but mostly conducted manually and stored internally
86		What are HRD's rules for AI access to production PII data, and what data access models are approved (e.g., direct, anonymized, synthetic)?	To be determined
87		Is a Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) required for AI tools that access or process PII?	Must maintain and adhere to standards outlined by FISMA, NIST 800-53 (for authentication), Privacy Act of 1974, Zero Trust Alignment
88		What de-identification or masking tools does HRD currently support for PII?	Internally conducted
89		What audit logging, monitoring, and interpretability standards must AI follow (including SIEM/SOAR integration)?	To be determined
90		What data residency or sovereignty constraints apply to AI data, models, and outputs?	OMB and DOI policies
91		How must AI-generated outputs containing PII be handled, retained, and disposed?	Must maintain and adhere to standards outlined by FISMA, NIST 800-53 (for authentication), Privacy Act of 1974, Zero Trust Alignment
92		Which manual SDLC tasks should AI automate first (e.g., builds, tests, deployments, change validation)?	To be determined
93		What development tools and IDEs are used?	Software AG, Natural for AJAX (Natural One)
94	Purpose of RFI	When the RFI references database management capabilities such as capacity, drift detection, patching, migrations, conversions, and integrity, should vendors assume these requirements apply only to non-production support tooling, or also to production database operations? Example: Advisory support only in lower environments, or direct production monitoring and controlled remediation.	Intention is application and utilization for all environments. Production, development, test
95	Purpose of RFI	Is there a preferred deployment model for the solution, such as on-premises, private enclave, or government-authorized cloud? Example: On-prem only, agency enclave in cloud, or hybrid deployment.	To be determined
96	Purpose of RFI	What forms of AI usage are acceptable in this environment? Example: Human-in-the-loop copilots, retrieval-augmented generation, offline models, no public API calls, and deterministic rule-based outputs.	Open to options or consideration and dependent for each environment
97	Purpose of RFI	Are there restrictions on where model inference, training, indexing, or vector storage may occur? Example: U.S.-only hosting, no external LLM endpoints, no training on government data, and vector databases hosted only in an agency enclave.	US Hosting Only, Rest of question To be determined
98	Purpose of RFI	What auditability requirements apply to AI-generated outputs for payroll, HR, legal guidance, documentation generation, and ticket routing? Example: Full prompt logging, output traceability, approval workflows, immutable audit histories, and versioned model records.	Yes to all here
99	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements; Purpose of RFI	The RFI states "Additional areas of interest include AI-enabled code and infrastructure analysis and refactoring (mainframe module assessment, call-routine mapping, bug identification, historical change analysis, and LLM-based scanning), automated generation of system documentation, training materials, and analytical reports, and customer service workflow automation (ticket creation and routing, self-service tools, legal and payroll guidance)." Could the Government clarify whether vendors will receive access to the existing mainframe source code and database schemas to support automated code analysis and refactoring activities, or whether such tools must be deployed directly within the Government's secured environment to perform those functions?	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and TBD how in depth or to what quantity and extent
100	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What primary source technologies are currently used across the IBC-HRD environment for application code, batch processing, database access, and interface handling? Example: COBOL, JCL, Natural, Easytrieve, REXX, SQL scripts, PowerShell, .NET, Java, file-transfer scripts, and scheduler definitions.	JCL, Natural, SQL scripts, Java, Flat files, SFTP, Connect Direct,
101	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What language variants, versions, compilers, and runtime environments are currently in use across the mainframe-centric payroll systems and supporting subsystems? Example: Enterprise COBOL 6.x, Natural 9.x, JCL on z/OS 2.5, DB2 utilities, WebSphere version, scheduler version, and Linux runtime versions.	Natural 9x, JCL, ZOS 2.5
102	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	If Natural or other programming languages are used, what is the estimated number of programs and total lines of code for each? Example: 1,200 Natural programs totaling 850,000 lines of code.	Upwards of 5mill for mainframe
103	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	If Natural is present in the environment, is it associated with ADABAS, and if so, what is the scope of ADABAS usage in terms of applications, files, and dependencies? Example: Natural/ADABAS used for payroll history, 40 ADABAS files, 12 dependent batch jobs, and 8 interfaces.	3,691 data elements, 488 file definitions

104	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	The RFI references extensive "JCL, ADBAS, batch scheduling, and interface dependencies." Please confirm whether "ADBAS" refers to ADABAS, and if so, which related products, utilities, and dependencies are in scope. Example: ADABAS, Natural, EntireX, Com-Plete, user exits, file loaders, and archive utilities.	ADABAS, Natural, file loaders, and archive utilities
105	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	If JCL is used, what is the approximate number of JCL members, procedures, and total lines of code? Example: 3,500 JCL members, 600 PROCs, and 275,000 total lines.	JCL 7, 796 jobs, 477,194 lines of code (JCL approx. 1311 jobs with 93,00 line of code)
106	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What is the approximate source code volume by language or artifact type across the in-scope environment? Example: COBOL 6.2M LOC, JCL 275k LOC, Natural 850k LOC, SQL scripts 120k LOC, and PowerShell 40k LOC.	Natural - Upwards of 7 mill for mainframe
107	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	Can IBC-HRD provide an approximate breakdown of the application landscape by function? Example: Payroll core 35 percent, personnel actions 15 percent, reporting 10 percent, ticketing 10 percent, batch processing 20 percent, and document generation 10 percent.	personnel 50% payroll 50%
108	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What portion of the environment remains mainframe-resident versus distributed, and which major functions are still exclusively tied to the mainframe estate? Example: Payroll calculation and year-end processing remain on z/OS, while reporting and portals are distributed.	80% mainframe/20% Natural AJAX/Linux
109	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What is the current batch-processing footprint in terms of job counts, processing frequency, runtime windows, scheduling dependencies, and critical payroll cycles? Example: 2,000 daily jobs, 400 biweekly payroll jobs, a 6-hour overnight processing window, and year-end W-2 and ACA peaks.	See above
110	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	Which job scheduling platforms and operational control tools are currently in use? Example: Control-M, CA-7, IBM Workload Scheduler, custom scheduler dashboards, and alerting tools.	Control-M
111	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What are the current database platforms, versions, and primary data management tools used across payroll and supporting subsystems? Example: DB2 12 for z/OS, ADABAS 8.x, SQL Server 2019, Oracle 19c, along with administration, backup, and monitoring tools.	ADABAS 8.6
112	Background: IBC as a Shared Services Provider	What is the approximate size of the data estate that may need to be assessed by the proposed AI tools? Example: 25 databases, 2,500 tables or files, 30 TB of structured data, and 5 TB of archived reports and documents.	35 TB
113	Objectives - "Automate and Produce"	For automated testing, what baseline artifacts are currently available? Example: Existing test cases, regression scripts, expected batch outputs, compare files, masked payroll datasets, and historical test run results.	No automated testing.
114	Objectives - "Automate and Produce"	For batch job-run comparisons and JCL validation, what are the highest-priority use cases for automation? Example: Return-code validation, spool comparison, dataset comparison, schedule dependency checks, and restartability checks.	Unknown at this time
115	Objectives - "Automate and Produce"	What test environments and sanitized or masked datasets can be made available for tool evaluation or future implementation? Example: Masked payroll extracts, synthetic personnel files, and prior production snapshots in a test enclave	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and TBD how in depth or to what quantity and extent. Possibly to be conducted during a technical session
116	Objectives - "Online/Production"	What categories of payroll errors (retroactivity, ACA, W-2, locality tax, timekeeping anomalies) must automation detect, explain, or avoid introducing?	Any and all - To be determined and discussed internally and with vendor
117	Objectives - "Online/Production"	What audit trails exist today for payroll adjustments, and how must AI-enhanced workflows maintain or expand these?	Audit trails are kept internally and stored in archived drives along within our current change management system
118	Objectives - "Analyze code and infrastructures"	When the RFI asks for the ability to "scan various LLMs in its entirety," does IBC-HRD mean scanning source code and infrastructure using LLM-enabled capabilities, or evaluating and governing multiple third-party LLM models within the environment? Example: Model security scanning, prompt and output monitoring, benchmark testing, or codebase analysis using AI tools.	Any and all - To be determined and discussed internally and with vendor
119	Objectives - "Self Help Feature"	Are there existing service management, knowledge management, or ticketing platforms that the solution must integrate with for customer service workflow automation? Example: ServiceNow, Jira, Remedy, SharePoint, Confluence, and custom DOI ticketing tools.	ServiceNow
120	Objectives - "Self Help Feature"	For the self-help and customer service capabilities, is the expectation employee-facing, agency HR staff-facing, payroll operations-facing, or all of the above? Example: Self-service for employees, case-assist for HR staff, and triage-assist for payroll operations.	Yes to all here

121	Objectives - "Self Help Feature"	For customer support and self-help automation, can the government elaborate on requirements, including: records retention requirements, integration with existing DOI knowledge repositories, or multilingual requirements? Example: English-only or multilingual support, seven-year retention, and integration with SharePoint or existing knowledge bases.	English only, I think seven-year retention, and yes likely potential integration with other existing knowledge bases (To be determined)
122	IBC-HRD Essentials - "Non-multi-tenant environments"	For "non-multi-tenant environments," is the expectation a single-tenant SaaS model, a customer-dedicated cloud enclave, an isolated private hosting model, or a fully on-premises deployment? Example: Dedicated government tenant with logical isolation, or a fully separate infrastructure stack.	To be determined
123	IBC-HRD Essentials - "Non-multi-tenant environments"	What level of FedRAMP maturity is expected for the proposed solution?	Must be FedRamp or going through Fedramp approvals/certification
124	Objectives - "Cross platform compatibility"	What are the primary interface types in the current environment? Example: Flat files, MQ, APIs, SFTP, Connect:Direct, email notifications, and scheduler-triggered handoffs.	Flat files, SFTP, Connect Direct, email notifications, scheduled triggered
125	IBC-HRD Essentials	Are there minimum availability, disaster recovery, or continuity of operations requirements that the solution must meet to be considered viable for payroll-related use? Example: 99.9 percent uptime, 4-hour RTO, 1-hour RPO, and year-end blackout support.	Yes, SLA uptime 95%; Disaster Recory within 24 hours RTO
126	Objectives - "Cross platform compatibility"	What standard interfaces and API specifications exist today for integrations with IRS, OPM, Treasury, and other SSPs (e.g., file formats, transport protocols, API definitions, exchange schedules)?	Flat files, SFTP, Connect Direct, batch retrieval and delivery, exchange schedules, APIs between Mulesoft and internal systems
127	Objectives - "Cross platform compatibility"	What evaluation criteria will HRD use to assess the maturity of AI tools (e.g., prior federal ATOs, model governance, explainability, reproducibility, performance benchmarks, accessibility conformance)?	Any and all - To be determined and discussed internally and with vendor
128	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Will access to representative source code, job control artifacts, interface definitions, and documentation be made available in any future assessment, pilot, or proofing activity so vendors can validate automation feasibility and implementation assumptions? Example: Read-only access to sample COBOL, JCL, Natural, interface specifications, test artifacts, and architecture diagrams.	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and TBD how in depth or to what quantity and extent and read only
129	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Are there restrictions on vendor use of automated analysis, refactoring, documentation, or testing tools during any future assessment or implementation effort? Example: No cloud-based scanning, no public LLMs, no source export, and use of approved tool lists only.	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and TBD how in depth or to what quantity and extent and read only
130	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Will vendors be expected to deliver production-ready, security-reviewed, and fully validated capabilities, or should vendors assume that portions of validation, accreditation, or final operational acceptance will be performed by DOI or another government support organization? Example: Vendor delivers deployment-ready capability, while DOI performs ATO, operational validation, and final acceptance testing.	To be determined - we acknowledge this may be a collaborative effort and open to further discussion
131	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Will vendors be provided with existing process documentation, workflow maps, business rules, ticket-routing logic, and knowledge-base content to support automation accuracy and reduce reverse-engineering effort? Example: SOPs, routing rules, service desk categories, decision trees, payroll process maps, and knowledge articles.	Upon direct market research and or pilot sessions, this is possible and TBD how in depth or to what quantity and extent
132	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Are there any incumbent tools, licenses, or platform investments already in place that DOI expects vendors to leverage, integrate with, or avoid duplicating? Example: Existing ServiceNow licenses, Splunk, SharePoint, Atlassian stack, database tools, and document repositories.	Preferred
133	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Are there any unique data-sharing, privacy, labor, union, or policy constraints specific to payroll and HR operations that could limit AI-assisted recommendations, automated actions, or user-facing self-service capabilities? Example: Approval requirements for HR actions, limits on PII exposure, union review requirements, and records retention constraints.	Yes
134	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements; Security and Compliance	If an Authority to Operate (ATO) is required, can HRD outline the anticipated path, roles (e.g., ISSO, AO), documentation expectations (SSP, POA&M), and a notional timeline for AI tooling to achieve ATO within HRD's environment?	Notional timeline 8 - 12 months
135	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements	Is HRD open to AI-enabled code conversion or selective mainframe-to-cloud augmentation (e.g., non-production analysis services, read-only mirrors, or batch offload), or must all automation operate entirely within the existing mainframe and Governmentmanaged environments?	Yes and open to further discussion
136	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements; Security and Compliance	Are there planned modernization efforts (e.g., rehosting, database upgrades, interface refreshes) that the AI solution should align with, and can HRD share relevant roadmaps or constraints?	TBD and open to further discussion

137	Section 2 – HRD AI Tools and Automations Requirements; Governance and Controls	What records-retention and eDiscovery expectations apply to AI-generated content and logs (e.g., prompt/output logs, model versions, routing decisions), and should vendors ensure that these records are stored in a way that prevents anyone from changing or deleting them, so they can be preserved for retention and legal discovery requirements?	Depends on record type, payroll requires min. 50 years retention.
138	Section 3 – Rough Order of Magnitude Annual Operations and Maintenance Costs	For annual operations and maintenance, should vendors include only tool support and hosting, or also ongoing tuning, model governance, test maintenance, integration support, and customer support services? Example: Hosting only, or a full managed service including monitoring, retraining, reporting, and user support.	Provide all, listed as separate line items
139	Objectives: Assess production and Test data	Can you provide more detail regarding your description of conversion of software? We'd like to ensure our definitions and expectations are aligned.	Unknown at this time
140	Objectives: Analyze code and infrastructure	Can you provide more detail regarding your description of refactoring code? We'd like to ensure our definitions and expectations are aligned.	Unknown at this time
141	Objectives: Customer service ticket generation	What ticketing system do you use?	ServiceNow
142	Objectives: Cross platform compatibility	Does integration with non-HRD systems mean managing file transfers, or are there direct application integrations?	Both
143	Mainframe Platform and OS Version	What IBM z/OS version and hardware generation is the IBC-HRD mainframe environment running? Understanding the platform baseline is necessary to assess AI code scanning and analysis tool compatibility.	ZOS 2.5 (3.2 scheduled for migration this FY)
144	Programming Language Stack	What is the primary language composition of the mainframe codebase (e.g., COBOL, PL/I, Assembler)? Is an approximate module count or lines-of-code estimate available to help vendors scope the code analysis workload?	Natural 9.x, approx. 7 mil lines of code with over 100,000 modules.
145	ADBAS Database Clarification	The RFI references "ADBAS." Does this refer to ADABAS (Software AG's Natural/ADABAS platform)? If so, what version is in use? This is a critical compatibility factor for any AI-based database assessment or code analysis tool.	Yes
146	FedRAMP Authorized vs. FedRAMP-Aligned	The RFI states solutions must support "FedRAMP-aligned controls." Does IBC-HRD require that AI tools be FedRAMP Authorized (active listing on the FedRAMP Marketplace), or is it sufficient to demonstrate alignment with FedRAMP control families without formal authorization? This distinction directly affects vendor qualification.	Must be FedRamp or going through Fedramp approvals/certification
147	Data Classification	What data classification levels are in scope? Is this PII only, or does the environment also include Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) or other designations that would impose additional security control requirements on the AI tool?	PII and CUI are handling classifications to be employed. Data is primarily UNCLASS
148	Deployment Environment	Will the AI tool be required to deploy within IBC-owned on-premises infrastructure, or is deployment to a FedRAMP-authorized government cloud environment (e.g., AWS GovCloud, Azure Government) acceptable provided the non-multi-tenant requirement is satisfied?	No not a requirements. All off premise recommendations must be FedRamp.
149	Contract Vehicle	Does IBC-HRD have a preferred acquisition vehicle for this procurement (e.g., GSA MAS, CIO-SP4, Alliance 2, or a standalone contract)? Confirming vehicle eligibility is a prerequisite for vendor participation planning	To be determined
150	Contract Period of Performance	What is the anticipated base period and option year structure? The RFI requests pricing scenarios across 5, 7, and 10-year horizons - is a 10-year period of performance under active consideration?	To be determined
151	Contract Vehicle Partner	Does IBC-HRD have a preferred partner with a contract vehicle?	No